

ence that there seems to be an app for just about anything! Today almost all businesses have a technological aspect, even if just a website. As the main aim of businesses is to attract a large number of consumers, UX has lately become a really big deal, to say the least!

To tell the story of UX however, we must begin with Usability. According to the ISO definition, Usability is “The extent to which a product can be used by specified users to



Edward Bernays

achieve specified goals with effectiveness, efficiency, and satisfaction in a specified context of use.” Usability emerged when the number of businesses in the domain of technology began to saturate. Soon, everyone had access to similar technologies, and no one had a clear competitive edge. The business leaders asked, “How can we make our product better?” but didn’t get convincing answers. This served to drive technology-oriented product development and design towards user-oriented development and design.

As far back as the World Wars, Edward Bernays had begun to invent the field of Public Relations, and developed the methods of swaying the masses via ‘engineering of consent’. Businesses couldn’t improve their products that much over their competitors, and so they used these techniques to focus on the perception of their product rather than the product itself. As time progressed, various branches stemmed and grew thicker and well-defined, such as Marketing and Usability. When the Users got the spotlight, those concerned with Usability asked questions like, “Is the user achieving his goal? What can we do to help the user achieve his goal faster and with less effort?” Many businesses started considering Usability to be the most useful metric, and started making designs and decisions accordingly. Some